



Moto X launched in India

After its successful stint with the Moto G, Flipkart launched the Moto X in India available for ₹23,999 <http://dgit.in/MotoXIndia>



Transparent speakers?

Clearview Clio are the world's first and only transparent wireless speakers featuring a single curved glass pane with a minimalistic design. <http://dgit.in/TranSpeak>

Bazaar

Sony VAIO Flip 13

Interesting hybrid, let down by poor build & expensive price

The Flip 13 carries a lot of the design elements from some of the recent VAIO notebook refreshes. The lid and the palmrest area get the brushed aluminum finish, and the single colour tone across the entire construction. However, the hybrid mechanism does make the lid thicker than what it ideally could have been.

Despite the use of materials that look good, there is quite a bit of flex at multiple points on the chassis, like the palmrest area, the lid and the base. The palmrest area dips in and creaks relatively easily even though your palms may just be resting there as you type. The materials look good and they don't feel bad at all, but the final build quality is definitely inadequate for this price tag.

With a name like Flip, one must assume by default that this is Sony's answer to Lenovo's largely successful line of Yoga notebooks. While the Yoga machines would twist and turn over backwards, the VAIO Flip actually does all the hybrid stuff, with the lid. Very smartly, the lid is divided into two, right down the middle. One half remains as it is, while the other has a hinge which allows you to push the display away from the lid by pressing at the back.

In the tablet "mode", the Flip 13 is fairly usable. But, at 1.3kg, it is primarily designed to be used as a laptop, with the additional flexibility of the tablet mode that you may use from time to time.

The 13.3-inch display is 1080p, and is among the crispest laptop screens in this size. The glass coating does make this somewhat glossy, but what you do get is adequate compensation with very good native brightness levels, vivid colours and very comfortable text readability. The IPS panel has advantages with colour accuracy and viewing angles.

The Flip 13's keyboard is similar to the island style keyboard seen on the other VAIO notebooks. The key size is adequate, but personally, I find the spacing a tad too much, so much so that the fingers have to search for the next key. Travel and response is also on the softer side, clearly an indication of how Sony have put this keyboard in without wanting to compromise on the predefined slimness of the machine. A large touch pad is a welcome addition though, and works well for multi-finger gestures, particularly makes scrolling a lot easier.

The unit has an Intel Core i5-4200U processor clocking at 1.6GHz, 4GB of RAM and a 128GB solid



state drive. This is the same processor that we have seen on many ultrabooks and laptops in the last few months, including Sony's own ultrabook. The benchmark scores don't scorch any charts, but the performance is consistent and smooth. The SSD is what makes a world of difference in terms of its performance. Thanks to its SSD, Windows boots up in around 5 seconds, and apps open and close quickly. You will hardly notice any system load even during heavy multitasking.

The battery life is something that is fairly impressive. In the stressing battery test, the VAIO Flip 13 clocked 226 minutes. While this is some distance away from the best battery life scores on laptops and ultrabooks, this 3.5 hours approx in the test will actually result in around minimum 5 hours of backup, in most usage scenarios.

Sony seems to have taken the idea of a Windows convertible to heart. The latest from them is the VAIO Flip 13, following on from the VAIO Duo. But, things aren't what they seem. In the traditional laptop mode, this is pretty much the ultrabook you would have wanted. But, the twisty and bendy bits aren't impressive, and the slide this out and twist this here process is something that you will have to remember - it doesn't come naturally. Unless you want an ultrabook that can do all the Matrix style show off, you would be better off spending this much money on a more conventional laptop or ultrabook. Alternatively, if the tablet mode is something that you really want as an additional capability for your laptop, then the Asus Taichi is an option, that does the same thing in a much neater way.

Vishal Mathur



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Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i5-4200U @ 1.6GHz; **RAM:** 4GB; **Storage:** 128GB SSD; **Display:** 13.3-inch IPS (1920 x 1080-pixel); **Graphics:** Intel HD; **OS:** Windows 8.1 (64-bit)

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